

KALEY BRAUER

NSF Astrophysics Postdoctoral Fellow
Institute for Theory and Computation, Harvard University
kaley.brauer@cfa.harvard.edu

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Physics	2023
Massachusetts Institute of Technology	
Thesis: <i>The Legacy of the First Galaxies</i>	
GPA: 5.0/5.0	
Sc.B. in Physics	2017
Brown University	
University honors, departmental honors, GPA: 4.0/4.0	

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

AI Alignment Research Fellow	2026 – present
Cambridge Boston Alignment Initiative; Anthropic advisor	
NSF Astrophysics Postdoctoral Fellow	2023 – present
Harvard University	
US Department of Energy Graduate Fellow; Graduate Researcher	2017 – 2023
Massachusetts Institute of Technology	
Visiting Research Fellow	Fall 2021
Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory	

HONORS & AWARDS

Research Corporation for Science Advancement Fellow	2025
NSF Astronomy & Astrophysics Postdoctoral Fellowship (\$330K; ~8 awarded annually)	2023
Spot Awards, MIT, <i>in recognition of community service to School of Science</i>	2020 & 2022
DOE Computational Science Graduate Fellowship (~\$450K; ~25 awarded annually)	2018
NSF Graduate Research Fellowship (~\$150,000)	2018
MIT Whiteman Fellowship (~\$100K)	2017
R. Bruce Lindsay Award, Brown University, <i>given to senior for excellence in physics</i>	2017
Eva A. Mooar Prize, Brown University, <i>given to woman for academic excellence</i>	2017
Sigma Xi Research Honor Society	2017
Karen T. Romer Undergraduate Teaching and Research Award, Brown University	2015

PUBLICATIONS

Refereed

Journal Articles

- Andersson, E. P., Rey, M. P., Yates, R. M., Read, J. I., Agertz, O., Ji, A. P., Mead, J., **Brauer, K.**, Mac Low, M. (2025). EDGE-INFERNO: The impact of chemical enrichment assumptions on the individual stars of a simulated faint dwarf galaxy. *submitted to The Astrophysical Journal*. arXiv:2511.05695

14. Hazlett, R., Mead, J., Visbal, E., Bryan, G., Mac Low, M., Kulkarni, M., Andersson, E. P., **Brauer, K.**, Wise, J. (2025). From Primordial Stars to Early Galaxies: A Semi-Analytic Model Calibrated with AEOS and Renaissance. *submitted to The Astrophysical Journal*. arXiv:2510.11629
13. Mead, J., **Brauer, K.**, Bryan, G. L., Mac Low, M. M., Ji, A. P., Wise, J. H., Andersson, E. P., Frebel, A., Emerick, A., Cote, B. (2025). AEOS is Mixing it Up: The (In)homogeneity of Metal Mixing Following Population III Star Formation. *submitted to The Astrophysical Journal*. arXiv:2509.13580
12. **Brauer, K.**, Mead, J., Ji, A. P., Wise, J. H., Bryan, G. L., Mac Low, M. M., Emerick, A., Andersson, E. P., Frebel, A., Cote, B. (2025). AEOS: The Impact of Pop III Initial Mass Function and Star-by-Star Models in Galaxy Simulations. *The Astrophysical Journal*, 993, 2.
11. Mead, J., **Brauer, K.**, Bryan, G. L., Mac Low, M. M., Ji, A. P., Wise, J. H., Emerick, A., Andersson, E. P., Frebel, A., Cote, B. (2025). AEOS: Transport of metals from minihalos following Population III stellar feedback. *The Astrophysical Journal*, 980, 62.
10. **Brauer, K.**, Emerick, A., Mead, J., Ji, A. P., Wise, J. H., Bryan, G. L., Mac Low, M. M., Cote, B., Andersson, E. P., Frebel, A. (2025). AEOS: Star-by-Star Cosmological Simulations of Early Chemical Enrichment and Galaxy Formation. *The Astrophysical Journal*, 980, 41.
9. Chiti, A., Mardini, M. K., Limberg, G., Frebel, A., Ji, A. P., Reggiani, H., Ferguson, P., Andales, H. D., **Brauer, K.**, Li, T. S., Simon, J. D. (2024). Signatures of Extragalactic First Stars in the Large Magellanic Cloud. *Nature Astronomy*, 8, 637647.
8. **Brauer, K.**, Andales, H., Ji, A. P., Mardini, M., Frebel, A., Gomez, F. A., & O’Shea, B. W. (2022). Possibilities and Limitations of Kinematically Identifying Stars from Accreted Ultra-Faint Dwarf Galaxies. *The Astrophysical Journal*, 937, 14.
7. Ji, A. P., Naidu, R., **Brauer, K.**, Ting, Y., & Simon, J. (2022). Chemical Abundances of the Typhon Stellar Stream. *Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society*, 519, 4467-4478.
6. Mardini, M., Frebel, A., Chiti, A., Meiron, Y., **Brauer, K.**, Ou, X. (2022). Characterization of the Metal Weak Thick Disk of the Milky Way. *The Astrophysical Journal*, 936, 78.
5. **Brauer, K.**, Ji, A. P., Drout, M., Frebel, A. (2021). Collapsar R-Process Yields Can Reproduce [Eu/Fe] Abundance Scatter in Metal-Poor Stars. *The Astrophysical Journal*, 915, 81.
4. Gull, M., Frebel, A., Hinojosa, K., Roederer, I. U., Ji, A. P., **Brauer, K.** (2021). R-process-rich stellar streams in the Milky Way. *The Astrophysical Journal*, 912, 52.
3. **Brauer, K.**, Ji, A. P., Frebel, A., Dooley, G. A., Gomez, F. A., & O’Shea, B. W. (2019). The Origin of r-process Enhanced Metal-Poor Halo Stars In Now-Destroyed Ultra-Faint Dwarf Galaxies. *The Astrophysical Journal*, 871, 247.
2. **Brauer, K.**, Vrtillek, S. D., Peris, C., & McCollough, M. (2018). Phase-resolved spectroscopy of the low-mass X-ray binary V801 Ara. *Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society*, 478, 4894-4904.

Refereed Workshop Papers

1. **Brauer, K.**, Dash, A. P., Vyas, M. J., Salim, A. (2025). From Simulations to Surveys: Domain Adaptation for Galaxy Observations. *Machine Learning and the Physical Sciences (ML4PS) Workshop at NeurIPS 2025*. arXiv:2511.18590

Non-Refereed

2. **Brauer, K.** (2021). “I’ll Finish it This Week” And Other Lies. *arXiv April Fools Paper*. arXiv:2103.16574
1. **Brauer, K.**, Ji, A., Hattori, K., Escobar, S., & Frebel, A. (2019). Kinematics of highly r-process-enhanced halo stars: Evidence for origins in now-destroyed ultra-faint dwarf galaxies. *Proceedings of the International Astronomical Union*, 14(S353), 71-74.

PRESENTATIONS

INVITED

Talk at Galactic Metal Cycles Workshop	County Galway, Ireland; May 2026
Theory Seminar Talk at UC San Diego	San Diego, CA, USA; Feb 2026
Talk at From Galaxies to Planets: An Elemental Journey	Ringberg Castle, Germany; Feb 2026
Colloquium Talk at Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute (RPI)	Troy, NY, USA; Oct 2025
Astronomy & Data Science Talk at Yale University	New Haven, CT, USA; May 2025
Astronomy Seminar Talk at Columbia University	New York, NY, USA; Mar 2025
Fundamental Physics Seminar Talk at Brown University	Providence, RI, USA; Mar 2025
Astronomy Seminar Talk at Lund University	Lund, Sweden; Mar 2025
Astronomy Seminar Talk at American Museum of Natural History	New York, NY, USA; Oct 2024
Nuclear Astrophysics Seminar Talk at IReNA	East Lansing, MI, USA; Sep 2024
Colloquium Summer Talk at Harvard-Smithsonian CfA	Cambridge, MA, USA; July 2023
Talk at US Department of Energy CSGF Program Review	Washington, DC, USA; July 2022
High Performance Computing Talks at IHPCSS	Athens, Greece; June 2022
Colloquium Talk at University of Melbourne	Melbourne, Australia; Oct 2021
Seminar Talk at Computational Research in Boston and Beyond	Boston, USA; Oct 2021
Seminar Talk at Carnegie Observatories	Pasadena, CA, USA; Oct 2020

CONTRIBUTED

Talk at NSF Postdoctoral Fellows Symposium 2026	Phoenix AZ, USA; Jan 2026
Poster at NeurIPS 2025 ML4PS Workshop	San Diego, CA, USA; Dec 2025
Talk at IAU Symposium 403 on Galactic Outskirts	Cordoba, Spain; Oct 2025
Poster at Tracing Cosmic Evolution with Clusters of Galaxies V	Sesto, Italy; July 2025
Talk at Galactic Frontiers II at Dartmouth	Hanover, CT, USA; Jun 2025
Talk at First Galaxies Meeting at Oxford	Oxford, UK; Apr 2025
Talk at NSF Postdoctoral Fellows Symposium 2025	Washington DC, USA; Jan 2025
Talk at IAU Symposium 395 on Stellar Populations	Paraty, Brazil; Nov 2024
Talk at Astrophysical Origins of Carbon	Tokyo, Japan; Sep 2024
Talk at First Stars VII at CCA	NYC, NY, USA; May 2024
Talk at Galaxies from Scratch 2024	Vienna, Austria; Feb 2024

Talk at 243rd Meeting of the American Astronomical Society	New Orleans, LA, USA; Jan 2024
Talk at NSF Postdoctoral Fellows Symposium 2024	New Orleans, LA, USA; Jan 2024
Talk at Flatiron CCA Galactic Frontiers	NYC, NY, USA; July 2023
Talk at IAU Symposium 377 on Early Disk Galaxy Formation	Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia; Feb 2023
Talk at 241st Meeting of the American Astronomical Society	Seattle, WA, USA; Jan 2023
Talk at JINA-CEE Frontiers in Nuclear Astrophysics Meeting	South Bend, IN, USA; May 2022
Talk at 2021 GALAH Science Meeting	Sydney, Australia; June 2021
Talk at <i>Linking the Galactic and Extragalactic</i>	Wollongong, Australia; Dec 2020
Talk at 235th Meeting of the American Astronomical Society	Honolulu, HI, USA; Jan 2020
Talk at IAU Symposium 353 on Galactic Dynamics	Shanghai, China; July 2019
Poster at JINA-CEE Frontiers in Nuclear Astrophysics Meeting	East Lansing, MI, USA; May 2019
Talk at JINA-CEE Frontiers in Nuclear Astrophysics Meeting	South Bend, IN, USA; May 2018
Poster at 229th Meeting of the American Astronomical Society	Grapevine, TX, USA; Jan 2017
Poster at 47th Meeting of the Division of Planetary Science	Washington, DC, USA; Nov 2015
Talk at SETI Institute's Summer Colloquium Series	Mountain View, CA, USA; Aug 2015

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming	Python, C/C++, MPI, OpenMP, GPU acceleration, Slurm, Git
Machine Learning	PyTorch, TensorFlow, HuggingFace, mechanistic interpretability

TEACHING

8.03 Vibrations and Waves Teaching Assistant	Spring 2023
<i>Physics Department, Massachusetts Institute of Technology</i>	
8.S30 Stellar Archaeology Teaching Assistant	Fall 2022
<i>Physics Department, Massachusetts Institute of Technology</i>	
High Performance Computing Summer School	Summer 2022
<i>International High Performance Computing Summer School; Athens, Greece</i>	
Cosmology Course Designer and Instructor	Spring 2021
<i>Spark, MIT Educational Studies Program</i>	
Catalyst Computer Science Instructor	Spring 2019
<i>Citizen Schools and Mass STEM Hub</i>	
PHYS0220/0270 Astronomy Teaching Assistant	Fall 2014 - Spring 2015
<i>Physics Department, Brown University</i>	
PHYS0030 Introductory Physics Workshop Assistant	Fall 2014
<i>Physics Department, Brown University</i>	

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

Leader & Mentor to Astronomy Graduate Students	2023 - present
<i>Astronomy Mentorship Program for Upcoming Postdocs (AMP-UP)</i>	

Subject-matter expert reviewer in NASA peer review <i>NASA</i>	2025 - present
Crew Scientist for Analog Astronaut Mission <i>Mars Desert Research Station</i>	Nov - Dec 2025
Pi Day Outreach Organizer <i>Harvard University</i>	2024 - 2025
Graduate Women in Physics Leader <i>Massachusetts Institute of Technology</i>	2019 - 2023
Reviewer for JOSS <i>Journal of Open Source Software</i>	2022 - present
President, MIT Salsa Club <i>Massachusetts Institute of Technology</i>	2018 - 2022
Physics Representative, Diversity and Inclusion Committee <i>MIT Graduate Student Council</i>	2018 - 2022
Treasurer, Students for the Exploration and Development of Space <i>Massachusetts Institute of Technology</i>	2017 - 2021
Adopt-a-Physicist Volunteer <i>Sigma Pi Sigma</i>	2018 - 2020
Observer & Designer, MIT Sidewalk Astrogazers <i>MIT Kavli Institute for Astrophysics and Space Research</i>	2017 - 2019
Head of Design Team, The Triple Helix Magazine <i>Brown University</i>	2014 - 2017
Women in Physics Co-coordinator <i>Brown University</i>	2016 - 2017
Physics Show Presenter <i>Physics & Astronomy Department, Texas A&M University</i>	Summer 2014